



LEGACY

FASHION

of this complex to explain their work across a network of artisans from different village clusters across the state of Rajasthan. Viral lays out hundreds of pichwai paintings, explaining the religious and cultural significance of each of these intricately hand painted masterpieces. This traditional style of painting on textiles, originated in the temple town of Nathdwara, but found royal patronage across India. Viral tells me that today there is a renewed interest in pichwai as an art form and is also being sought after by the emporium's international clientele, seeking to invest in Indian art. It is important for us push this craft out as much as possible, to get people to buy, collect and showcase pichwai", he says. We are in close contact with our clusters of artisans and ensure that the art form is being spoken about extensively.

Jaipur is potentially India' most talked about city when it comes to ancient arts and crafts, patronised by royal families. An afternoon with octogenarian, Jaswant Meenakari, in the heart of Jaipur's Pink City reveals the most incredible pearls about his generations-long association with the art of meenakari, specialised by his family. Jaswant, whose son and granddaughter have also taken on the profession, have been quietly creating some of the country's finest meenakari work. Down the road, at an annexe of the iconic City Palace, Gauravi Kumari, member of the erstwhile royal family of Jaipur has been doing her part to preserve different art forms too. Gauravi helms the Princess Diya Kumari Foundation Store (PDKF), working with almost 70 different artisans to promote art forms like block print, sozani, tangaliya and Patwa jewellery. Block prints from Jaipur remain the signature offering at PDKF and given Gauravi's social media savvy approach as well as her penchant for marketing, the brand and the art form has seen several takers. As a result, Jaipur's block prints are now trending globally.

While the revival of ancient art forms in India, earlier patronised by the erstwhile royals, are now being carefully packaged, painstakingly marketed and beautifully showcased to the world, it would be grave injustice to limit this scope to a feature in this issue, so expect a part deux of this story. Until then we move from past perfect to present continuous...